

Population up 25% in a decade?

An IMF staff paper, tested against Eurostat's demographic accounts

THE CLAIM

“Malta’s population rose by 25 percent over a decade, largely due to immigration.”

IMF staff, Malta: Selected Issues (Country Report No. 26/30), February 2026

A parenthesis in a list of drivers of the housing boom.

The paper gives no years, so we tested every ten-year window to 2026.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

*Migration-driven growth is right;
25% is low for the latest decade.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

+30.9%

Latest decade, 2015–2025

438,805 to 574,250 people. The latest decade available when the paper was written.

+24.6%

Decades ending 2020–2022

Growth was 24.4–24.6%: these are the decades that match the 25%.

96%

Share from net migration

Net migration was 93–97% of growth in every decade since 2010–2020.

+1.9%

EU-27, 2015–2025

Malta grew about sixteen times faster than the EU over the same decade.

588,254

Population, 1 Jan 2026

Up from 402,668 in 2005. Matches the NSO's end-2025 figure (CC-088).

FAIR TO SAY

The figure errs low, so it does not exaggerate the point it supports: population growth has added to housing demand.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ IMF staff: the years behind “a decade”.

☐ IMF staff: the data source used.

☐ Readers: say which decade you mean.

☐ NSO: census-consistent back series.